

Friday, 21 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

20° 14°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

19° 13°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

18° 12°

GLASGOW

Overcast

18° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 A school in Ealing is deeply saddened after one of their pupils and her family died in the sea off Shoreham.

Ellen Wilkinson School for Girls paid tribute to 14-year-old Sara El-Khawas and her family. The incident has sent shockwaves through the community.

TRAGEDY · UK

2 A new weekly insulin jab could soon replace daily injections for hundreds of thousands of people with type 2 diabetes.

This potential breakthrough offers a more convenient way to manage the condition. It could significantly improve the quality of life for many.

HEALTH · UK

3 A flying club has paid tribute to a 'very popular' member and his wife who tragically died in a plane crash.

Ketan Swali and Sheetal Swali, from Leicestershire, were pronounced dead at the scene in Gwynedd. The aviation community is mourning their loss.

TRAGEDY · UK

4 Hundreds of people across the UK have fallen ill with salmonella infections in an outbreak linked to imported eggs.

Health authorities are investigating the source and advising consumers on precautions. It's a serious public health concern.

HEALTH · UK

5 An 83-year-old pensioner from Scotland has been found with what's believed to be the largest hoard of child abuse images ever seized in the country.

Alan MacPherson amassed two million indecent images. This shocking discovery highlights a dark and disturbing crime.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1 **The National Television Awards have made history, with their first ever all-female shortlist for the Drama Acting award!**

The five incredible actresses in the running are Ella Bruccoleri, Sheridan Smith, Ruth Jones, Vicky McClure, and Judy Parfitt. It's a brilliant year for female talent on our screens.

ON AIR – Who do you think deserves to win the Drama Acting award this year?

AWARDS · COMING UP

2 **Good news for music fans heading to Reading Festival, as it's been granted a music extension despite some noise concerns!**

Charli XCX, rapper Dave, and Chase & Status are set to headline the festival later this month. It means more time for everyone to enjoy the fantastic live acts.

ON AIR – Are you heading to Reading Festival this year, and who are you most excited to see?

MUSIC · COMING UP

3 **Ariana Grande's highly anticipated tour has arrived in the UK, with the star playing the first of ten dates in London!**

After these UK shows, Ariana has announced she'll be stepping back from public life for a while. So, it's a special chance for fans to catch her live.

ON AIR – Are you an Ariana Grande fan, and have you managed to get tickets for her UK shows?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

4 **Young star Bella Ramsey admits she wishes she had been a more rebellious teenager!**

Bella is starring in a new film about a cancer survivor who finds friendship and freedom at 'chemo camp'. It sounds like a powerful and uplifting story.

ON AIR – Do you ever wish you'd been a bit more rebellious in your youth?

FILM · COMING UP

5 **If you're planning on heading to Reading Festival next week, organisers are urging everyone to plan ahead for its impact.**

The huge music festival kicks off next Thursday and runs until Sunday the 30th. It's always a big event, so good advice to get organised!

ON AIR – Any top tips for surviving a big music festival like Reading?

MUSIC · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **The new Premier League season is almost here, and pundits are making their predictions for the top four!**

Twenty-six football experts have weighed in on who they think will win the title and secure those coveted Champions League spots. It's always fun to see who gets it right.

ON AIR – Who are your picks for the Premier League top four this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **The Premier League is introducing a new plan to tackle the 'corner chaos' that became an 'epidemic' last season.**

We're talking about all the holding, pushing, and grappling in the box during set pieces. It'll be interesting to see if these new measures make a difference.

ON AIR – Do you think the new rules for corners will make the game better, or is it just more fuss?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Camilo Duran's incredible double has edged Celtic closer to a place in the Champions League!**

He scored two excellent goals in the first leg of their play-off against Austria's LASK, including a stunning volley. What a performance!

ON AIR – How important is it for Scottish clubs like Celtic to be competing in the Champions League?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **England's Ollie Robinson and Josh Tongue had a day to remember, both taking five-wicket hauls against Pakistan!**

They bowled Pakistan out for 171 on day one of the first Test at Headingley. What a fantastic start for England in the series!

ON AIR – Which England bowler has impressed you most this summer?

CRICKET · UK

5 **Cyclist Josh Tarling is set to ride in the Vuelta a Espana after the tragic death of his brother.**

His 19-year-old brother Finlay died in a high-speed collision with a van during the Volta a Portugal. It's an incredibly brave decision for Josh to compete.

ON AIR – What an incredibly strong thing to do – to compete after such a personal tragedy.

CYCLING · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A delightful trend is seeing more people embrace the art of 'upcycling' old furniture.**
Instead of discarding items, individuals are creatively transforming them into something new and functional, adding a unique touch to their homes and reducing waste.
- 2 The simple pleasure of 'baking bread from scratch' is experiencing a heartwarming resurgence across the UK.**
More households are enjoying the therapeutic process and the delicious reward of a freshly baked loaf, often sharing their creations with neighbours.
- 3 Experts suggest that 'taking a mindful pause' to observe the clouds can significantly enhance daily well-being.**
This free and accessible practice encourages a moment of calm and observation, helping to reduce stress and foster a sense of connection to nature.
- 4 The charming tradition of 'leaving positive messages on public chalkboards' is bringing smiles to communities.**
From uplifting quotes to encouraging doodles, these small acts of kindness are brightening pavements and surprising passers-by.
- 5 A new study highlights the cognitive benefits of 'learning a musical instrument' at any age.**
It's never too late to pick up a guitar or dust off the piano, as it can improve memory, coordination, and even mood.
- 6 The humble 'charity shop' is becoming a treasure trove for fashion enthusiasts seeking unique vintage finds.**
Beyond sustainability, shoppers are discovering one-of-a-kind garments and accessories that stand out from mainstream trends.
- 7 Research shows that 'walking barefoot on grass' can be surprisingly beneficial for stress reduction.**
Connecting directly with nature, even for a few minutes, can have a grounding effect and promote a sense of calm.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new pair of shoes will be comfortable for a whole day?

ANSWER: WEARING THEM AROUND THE HOUSE WITH OUR INDOOR SLIPPERS ON ONE FOOT AND THE NEW SHOE ON THE OTHER.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh cup of tea from a brand new box of teabags. What is it?

ANSWER: SNIFFING THE UNOPENED TEABAG BOX DEEPLY, JUST TO GET THAT COMFORTING, DRY TEA AROMA.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'smell from a kitchen' just instantly transports you back to a specific memory or a lovely moment in time?

Perhaps it's the scent of freshly baked biscuits from your grandmother's kitchen, or the aroma of a Sunday roast that reminds you of family gatherings. What is that smell for you, and what memory does it evoke?

- We all have those 'little everyday objects' that we couldn't do without, even if they seem insignificant to others, don't we?

It might be a particular mug for your morning cuppa, a well-worn gardening glove, or that specific pen that just writes perfectly. What's your indispensable everyday object, and why is it so special to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a parliament.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Dogs can actually smell human emotions, which helps them comfort us when we're sad.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The 'sixth sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is believed to be the toughest tongue twister in the English language.
- It is illegal to sing in public after 9 pm in Honolulu, Hawaii, if you are wearing your swimsuit.
- The inventor of the Pringle can, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one.
- A flock of flamingos is called a flamboyance.
- The longest place name in the world is Taumatawhakatangihangakoauauotamateaturipukakapikimaungahoronukupokaiwhenuakitanatahu in New Zealand.
- Before the invention of rubber erasers, breadcrumbs were commonly used to rub out pencil marks.

On this day

Day 233 of the year, 132 days left in 2026. Today Christian Feast Day: Abraham of Smolensk (Eastern Orthodox Church); Christian Feast Day: Bernard of Alzira; Christian Feast Day: Cyriaca; Christian Feast Day: Euprepus of Verona. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1939 — James Burton, American Hall of Fame guitarist
- 1962 — Cleo King, American actress
- 1986 — Brooks Wheelan, American comedian and actor
- 1991 — Jesse Rutherford, American singer and songwriter
- 1975 — Alicia Witt, American actress and musician
- 1978 — Alan Lee, Irish footballer and coach
- 1968 — Dina Carroll, English singer-songwriter
- 1984 — Neil Dexter, South African cricketer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1991 — Coup attempt against Mikhail Gorbachev collapses.
- 1995 — Atlantic Southeast Airlines Flight 529, an Embraer EMB 120 Brasilia, attempts to divert to West Georgia Regional Airport after the left engine fails, but the aircraft crashes in Carroll County near Carrollton, Georgia, killing nine of the 29 people on board.
- 1994 — Royal Air Maroc Flight 630 crashes in Douar Izounine, Morocco, killing all 44 people on board.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1140 — Song dynasty general Yue Fei defeats an army led by Jin dynasty general Wuzhu at the Battle of Yancheng during the Jin–Song Wars.
- 1986 — Carbon dioxide gas erupts from volcanic Lake Nyos in Cameroon, killing up to 1,800 people within a 20-kilometre (12 mi) range.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1991 — Latvia declares renewal of its full independence after its occupation by the Soviet Union since 1940.

1983 — Philippine opposition leader Benigno Aquino Jr. is assassinated at Manila International Airport (now renamed Ninoy Aquino International Airport in his honor).

- 1918 — World War I: The Second Battle of the Somme begins.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 234 of the year, 131 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Immaculate Heart of Mary (Roman Catholic calendar of 1960); Christian feast day: John Kemble; Christian feast day: Queenship of Mary; Christian feast day: Blessed Symeon Lukach. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1967 — Adewale Akinnuoye-Agbaje, English actor
- 1994 — Israel Broussard, American actor
- 1936 — Chuck Brown, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer (died 2012)
- 1936 — Dale Hawkins, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2010)
- 1973 — Howie Dorough, American singer-songwriter and dancer
- 1986 — Stephen Ireland, Irish footballer
- 1967 — Ty Burrell, American actor and comedian
- 1939 — Valerie Harper, American actress (died 2019)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1978 — The District of Columbia Voting Rights Amendment is passed by the U.S. Congress, although it is never ratified by a sufficient number of states.
- 2006 — Pulkovo Aviation Enterprise Flight 612 crashes near the Russian border over eastern Ukraine, killing all 170 people on board.
- 2004 — Versions of The Scream and Madonna, two paintings by Edvard Munch, are stolen at gunpoint from a museum in Oslo, Norway.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2006 — Grigori Perelman is awarded the Fields Medal for his proof of the Poincaré conjecture in mathematics but refuses to accept the medal.
- 1962 — The OAS attempts to assassinate French president Charles de Gaulle.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

22–23

Belgian Grand Prix (F1)